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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS)

REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCJMC201, MG4DSCPJM201- PUBLIC RELATIONS AND CORPORATE COMMUNICATION

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks : 70**

PART A — Multiple Choice Questions

1 d) Publics

2 c) Credibility

3 a) The visual and verbal elements that distinguish an organisation

4 c) Managing corporate identity, reputation, and stakeholder relations

5 b) Integrating internal, external, and investor relations under one strategic umbrella

6 c) Local community

7 c) Advocacy Advertising

8 b) Niche Agencies

9 b) A manager issuing official policy guidelines to team members

10 b) Edelman India

PART B — Short Answer Questions *(3 Marks)*

11. PRSI

- Public Relations Society of India, founded in 1958, is the apex body representing PR professionals in India
- It promotes ethical standards, professional development, and recognition of PR as a strategic discipline
- Organises national conventions, awards, and training programmes for PR practitioners across India

12. Two-way Communication in Governmental PR

- Two-way communication enables governments to both disseminate information and receive public feedback, ensuring responsive governance
- Examples include public consultations on policy, grievance redressal portals, and town hall meetings
- It builds public trust, reduces misinformation, and ensures that government decisions reflect citizen needs

13. Crisis Communication in Corporate Communication

- Crisis communication involves managing information flow during emergencies to protect organisational reputation and maintain stakeholder trust

- It includes preparing crisis communication plans, designating spokespersons, and ensuring timely, transparent messaging
- Effective crisis communication minimises reputational damage and demonstrates organisational accountability and responsibility

14. Points for Preparing Publicity Messages
    - Messages must be accurate, newsworthy, timely, and tailored to the target audience and chosen media platform
    - Language should be clear, concise, and free of jargon, with a strong lead that captures attention immediately
    - Messages should align with organisational objectives and maintain consistency with the overall brand identity and tone
15. Pillars of CSR
    - CSR operates on the pillars of economic responsibility (profitability), legal responsibility (compliance), ethical responsibility (fair conduct), and philanthropic responsibility (community contribution)
    - It is guided by the principle that organisations have obligations beyond profit-making towards society and the environment
    - Stakeholder engagement, transparency, and sustainability are central to effective CSR practice
16. Importance of House Journals
    - House journals serve as internal communication tools that keep employees informed, motivated, and aligned with organisational goals and values
    - They strengthen organisational culture, foster a sense of belonging, and recognise employee achievements
    - Externally directed house journals also enhance corporate image and maintain relationships with clients, partners, and stakeholders
17. Characteristics of an Effective PR Message
    - Must be clear, credible, consistent, and tailored to the specific audience and communication channel
    - Should be timely, factually accurate, and aligned with the organisation's overall communication strategy
    - An effective PR message evokes the desired response — whether awareness, attitude change, or action — without being overtly promotional
18. Role of Account Management in a PR Agency
    - The account management department serves as the primary liaison between the PR agency and its clients, managing relationships and ensuring client satisfaction
    - It coordinates the work of creative, media, and research teams to deliver campaigns aligned with client objectives
    - Account managers handle project timelines, budgets, reporting, and strategic counsel to clients
19. Branding in PR and Corporate Communication
    - Branding in PR refers to the strategic process of creating and maintaining a distinct, positive identity and reputation for an organisation in the minds of its publics
    - It encompasses visual identity (logo, colours), verbal identity (tone, messaging), and behavioural identity (values, conduct)

- Consistent branding across all communication channels builds trust, recognition, and long-term stakeholder loyalty

20. In-house PR Department vs. External PR Agency

- An in-house PR department consists of employees within the organisation who have deep institutional knowledge but may lack objectivity and diverse expertise
- An external PR agency is an independent firm hired on a contractual basis, offering fresh perspectives, specialised skills, and broader industry experience
- Organisations often use both in combination — in-house teams managing day-to-day communication while agencies handle campaigns and crisis situations

21. Lack of Objectivity in In-house PR Teams

- In-house PR professionals may develop organisational loyalty that compromises their ability to critically assess and communicate difficult or negative information
- This lack of objectivity can lead to biased messaging, delayed crisis response, and reluctance to advise against management decisions
- It undermines credibility with media and external publics who may perceive in-house communication as self-serving

22. Emotional Intelligence in PR Management

- Emotional intelligence (EI) enables PR professionals to understand and manage their own emotions while empathising with stakeholders, clients, and media representatives
- High EI improves conflict resolution, crisis communication, and relationship-building with diverse publics
- PR managers with strong EI are better equipped to craft empathetic messaging, navigate sensitive situations, and maintain composure under pressure

PART C — Essay Questions *(15 Marks)*

23. PR vs. Publicity Stunt

- PR is a planned, sustained, and strategic process aimed at building long-term mutual understanding between an organisation and its publics
- Publicity stunts are short-term, attention-grabbing tactics that may generate media coverage but lack strategic depth or relationship-building intent
- PR is grounded in ethics, credibility, and two-way communication; publicity stunts risk damaging reputation if perceived as manipulative or insincere
- PR encompasses diverse functions — media relations, community engagement, crisis communication, CSR — while a publicity stunt is a single tactical event
- Long-term organisational reputation is built through consistent PR practice, not isolated stunts that may attract momentary attention without lasting goodwill

24. Roles and Functions of Corporate Communication

- Managing corporate identity and ensuring consistent visual and verbal brand representation across all internal and external communication
- Reputation management — proactively shaping public perception and responding to threats through media relations and stakeholder engagement

- Internal communication — keeping employees informed, motivated, and aligned through newsletters, intranets, and town halls
- Crisis communication — developing preparedness plans and managing organisational messaging during emergencies to protect reputation
- Investor relations, CSR communication, and government/public affairs — maintaining trust and transparency with all key stakeholder groups

25. Step-by-step Process of Designing a PR Campaign

- Fact-finding/Research — conducting situational analysis, audience research, and SWOT analysis to understand the communication environment
- Goal-setting and Objectives — defining SMART objectives aligned with organisational communication goals
- Strategy and Planning — identifying target publics, key messages, communication channels, timelines, and budget
- Implementation/Execution — deploying tactics such as press releases, events, social media campaigns, and community outreach
- Evaluation — measuring outcomes against objectives using media monitoring, surveys, reach analytics, and stakeholder feedback to assess campaign effectiveness

26. Purpose of PR Campaigns and Types

- PR campaigns are organised, purposeful communication efforts designed to achieve specific objectives — building awareness, changing attitudes, managing crises, or promoting causes
- Awareness campaigns introduce new products, services, or issues to the public and generate media coverage
- Reputation/Image campaigns are used to rebuild or enhance public trust, particularly following negative publicity or crises
- Advocacy campaigns seek to influence public policy, legislation, or social attitudes on behalf of the organisation or a cause
- Internal campaigns target employees to build morale, communicate change, or reinforce organisational values and culture